



Drew Dudley Biographies and Sample Introduction - 2025

High Definition Headshots can be [downloaded here](#).

Drew Dudley Biography (Short)



Fifteen years ago, Drew Dudley was the head of Canada's largest leadership program at the University of Toronto when a group of his students secretly nominated him to deliver a [TED Talk](#) that went on to be voted one of the "15 Most Inspirational TED Talks of All Time" and gave Drew the opportunity to travel the world trying to redefine leadership for as many people as possible.

Now a Wall Street Journal Bestselling Author, speaker and educator, Drew is on a mission to help people unlearn some dangerous lessons about leadership. With clients that have included some of the world's most dynamic organizations—including the United Nations and over 100 colleges and universities—Drew draws on over two decades of experience to blend humor, storytelling and easy-to-implement strategies into some of the most engaging and practical leadership presentations in the world. Both *TIME* and *Business Insider* have identified his work as "one of the ten speeches that will make you a better leader." Drew currently teaches at the University of California Irvine, acts as co-host of the "[Good Company](#)" [podcast](#) and splits his time between Toronto, Canada and Washington, DC.

Drew Dudley Biography (Extended)



Somewhere around the middle of his undergraduate education, Drew realized engaging with the world was a lot more fun than writing papers about it. While still a student he became heavily involved in Canada's largest post-secondary charitable initiative in support of [Cystic Fibrosis Canada](#), eventually serving as the National Chair of the organization. As he moved into his career, he took on the challenge of creating and building the Leadership

Development Program at the University of Toronto, which became the largest and most dynamic in the country.

It was those leadership students who changed the course of Drew's professional life: they secretly organized a campaign to put him onstage at TEDxToronto 2010, where he [delivered a talk](#) that would go on to generate more than 5 million views around the web. A high-achieving lifestyle took its toll however: undiagnosed bipolar disorder set the foundation for binge eating and drinking, and Drew grew to over 300 pounds while struggling with the emotional challenges of a career that kept him on the road 250 days a year.

Drew credits the Day One process with saving his life—he began applying the process to improving his mental and physical health. Recognizing how many people were struggling silently with similar

battles, Drew began infusing these experiences into his keynotes, hoping to remind people that their scars in no way stand in the way of their leadership.

In 2018, Drew shared both his story and the Day One process in his first book [*This is Day One: A Practical Guide to Leadership That Matters*](#). Today, Drew continues to travel the world sharing the Day One process with organizations of all kinds—aiming to redefine leadership for as many people as possible.

Drew currently teaches at the University of California Irvine, acts as co-host of [the “Good Company” podcast](#) and splits his time between Toronto, Canada and Washington, DC.

Drew Dudley Sample Introduction for Event Day (feel free to adjust)



Our speaker today is a bestselling leadership author, educator and speaker who stands at the forefront of the global conversation on personal leadership development. Beginning his career by building Canada’s largest university leadership program at the University of Toronto, Drew has spent the last two decades trying to redefine leadership for as many people as possible.

His clients have included some of the world’s largest and most dynamic organizations, including Coca-Cola, American Express, JP Morgan Chase, the United Nations and over 100 colleges and universities. Both TIME and Business Insider have called his presentation “one of the ten speeches that will make you a better leader”.

Drew’s first book, “This is Day One: A Practical Guide to Leadership That Matters” debuted at #6 on the Wall Street Journal Bestseller list and has gone on to become an international bestseller, while his TED Talk, “Everyday Leadership: The Lollipop Moment” has been named “one of the fifteen most inspirational TED Talks of all time.”

Please welcome Drew Dudley!